



A MOBILE JOURNEY THROUGH THE ARCHIPELAGO

BEYOND THE ORDINARY

DISCOVER THE PHILIPPINES

Text and imagery unfold on separate screens -
designed for an unhurried vertical read.



START HERE

The Philippines, at a glance

An archipelago best understood not by ticking off islands, but by noticing how landscape, language and hospitality change from one crossing to the next.

ARCHIPELAGO

More than 7,600 islands across Luzon, Visayas and Mindanao.

LANGUAGE

Filipino and English are official; many regional languages are spoken.

CURRENCY

Philippine peso (PHP). Cards are common in cities; cash matters in remote areas.

CLIMATE

Tropical and maritime. Dry season generally December-May; rainfall varies by region.

TIME

UTC+8.

POPULATION

112,729,484 people at the July 2024 census.

CORON, PALAWAN

An archipelago shaped by sea passages, limestone islands and the daily rhythm of the banca.





TRAVEL WELL

Before the first crossing

A little preparation protects the freedom to explore.

ENTRY

Many visa-exempt visitors are admitted for 30 days. Verify current rules for your nationality.

GETTING AROUND

Private vehicles, domestic flights, ferries and bancas each form part of the journey.

MONEY

Carry small peso notes before mountain and coastal sectors.

WEATHER

Pack for sun, tropical rain and changing regional conditions.

CONNECTIVITY

Keep essential documents and maps available offline.



MANILA | LAYERS OF HISTORY

The city behind the walls

Manila first feels kinetic - jeepneys flashing past glass towers, vendors calling from side streets, and sudden pockets of tropical shade. Inside Intramuros, the tempo changes as stone gateways open onto courtyards, churches and stories of trade, faith and revolution.

A UNESCO TREASURE

San Agustin Church, completed in 1607, forms part of UNESCO's Baroque Churches of the Philippines. Its carved doors, painted ceiling and cloisters reveal centuries of Filipino and European craftsmanship.

THE EXPERIENCE

Walk Fort Santiago's ramparts, follow the story of national hero José Rizal, then cross the old streets by kalesa. Contemporary galleries, ancestral gold and a long Filipino lunch bring the many Manilas together.

INTRAMUROS, MANILA

Stone gateways, kalesas and living history in the heart of the capital.





BANAUE | LIVING ENGINEERING

Where mountains remember

The first sight of Batad is almost impossible to take in at once: an amphitheatre of green steps folding around a village. Footpaths narrow to terrace walls, irrigation water threads downhill, and every turn reveals work carried across generations.

UNESCO WORLD HERITAGE

Batad and Bangaan are among five clusters in the Rice Terraces of the Philippine Cordilleras - a living Ifugao cultural landscape where forest stewardship, water systems, farming and ritual remain inseparable.

THE EXPERIENCE

A local guide turns scenery into human history, pointing out granaries, stonework, planting cycles and family plots. Travellers often remember the sound as vividly as the view: water moving between paddies and distant voices rising from the valley.

BATAD, IFUGAO

A living cultural landscape shaped by water, farming knowledge and generations of care.





SAGADA | RITUAL LANDSCAPE

Listen to the highlands

Sagada sits among pine forest, limestone caves and cool mountain air. Dawn mist lifts slowly from the valleys; paths descend through ferns and rock; cafés and village lanes give the town a reflective rhythm unlike the tropical coast.

ANCESTRAL HERITAGE

In Echo Valley, coffins placed high on limestone cliffs express long-held Kankanaey funerary traditions and a continuing relationship between ancestors, community and landscape.

THE EXPERIENCE

Follow a guide beneath the pines as church bells fade behind you, or enter Sumaguig Cave where water-polished rock catches the torchlight. The reward is the atmosphere of an entire mountain world.

SAGADA, MOUNTAIN PROVINCE

Pine forest, limestone caves and Kankanaey ancestral traditions.





VIGAN | A CITY OF EXCHANGE

History at walking pace

At first light, Calle Crisologo belongs to footsteps, bicycle bells and the occasional kalesa. Capiz-shell windows glow above old shopfronts; timber upper floors lean over cobbles polished by rain, trade and generations of daily life.

UNESCO WORLD HERITAGE

Founded in the 16th century, Vigan is UNESCO's best-preserved example of a planned Spanish colonial town in Asia. Its architecture combines Philippine and Chinese traditions with European and Mexican influences.

THE EXPERIENCE

Enter an ancestral house, meet inabel weavers and notice hand-cut ventanillas and cool courtyards. Then taste the region through empanada, bagnet and richly savoury Ilocano cooking.

CALLE CRISOLOGO, VIGAN

A UNESCO city where Asian and colonial building traditions meet.





DONSOL | OCEAN GIANTS

Follow the butanding

The boat leaves while the coast is still soft with morning haze. Eyes scan the surface for a dark shape or the flick of a fin; then the signal comes, the sea closes overhead, and a whale shark materialises from blue water with astonishing calm.

A GLOBAL ECO-TOURISM STORY

Donsol became internationally known for encounters with wild butanding in their natural habitat. The community-based programme uses trained interaction officers and operates without artificial feeding.

THE EXPERIENCE

Underwater, the animal's spotted pattern sharpens as it glides past, immense yet unhurried. On land, Bicol continues the story through quiet fishing communities, mangrove rivers and fireflies gathering after dark.

DONSOL, SORSOGON

A wild whale-shark encounter led by trained local interaction officers.





BOHOL | ISLAND DEEP TIME

An island raised from the sea

From a ridge in Bohol's interior, the Chocolate Hills roll toward the horizon in hundreds of near-symmetrical cones. Their changing colours tell the season, while their limestone holds a much older memory of coral seas and tectonic uplift.

UNESCO GLOBAL GEOPARK

Designated in 2023, Bohol Island is the Philippines' first UNESCO Global Geopark. Its geological story spans more than 150 million years and includes caves, sinkholes, cone karst and the Danajon Double Barrier Reef.

THE EXPERIENCE

Country roads connect the hills with forest sanctuaries where Philippine tarsiers cling quietly to slender branches. Later, Panglao opens into white sand, clear shallows and warm water at sunset.

CHOCOLATE HILLS, BOHOL

The Philippines' first UNESCO Global Geopark and an island of extraordinary karst landscapes.





MOALBOAL | THE LIVING SEA

Enter the silver current

Only metres from shore, the reef edge falls away and the water suddenly fills with motion. Hundreds of thousands of sardines compress, scatter and turn together, flashing silver whenever sunlight breaks through the surface.

A RARE YEAR-ROUND SPECTACLE

Moalboal's sardine aggregation is remarkable for its accessibility close to Panagsama Beach. Snorkellers watch from above while divers descend beside the moving shoal.

THE EXPERIENCE

Slip into the water early, when the sea is quiet and shafts of light reach the reef. A turtle may rise from the coral slope while jacks circle below. The sensation is of entering a living current.

MOALBOAL, CEBU

A vast sardine aggregation gathering close to the reef edge at Panagsama.





CEBU | CROSSROADS OF THE VISAYAS

Where stories converge

Cebu is both an island world and an historic port: ferries arriving, church bells carrying over downtown streets, mountain ridges beyond the city and beaches opening along the coast. Its energy comes from centuries of movement and exchange.

A HISTORIC HEART

The Basilica Minore del Santo Niño safeguards one of the country's most revered religious images. Magellan's Cross, Fort San Pedro and ancestral houses reveal Cebu's place in faith, colonial trade and civic life.

THE EXPERIENCE

Move from coral-stone walls into the flavours of the Visayas - lechon, mango, seafood and smoky grills. Along Mactan's shoreline, history gives way to palms, warm shallows and resort ease.

MACTAN, CEBU

A resort shoreline beside one of the Philippines' most historic island cities.





THE THREAD BETWEEN PLACES

Come to the table

Travel becomes personal over shared dishes: the explanation of a recipe, the second helping, the story that would never fit inside a tour commentary.

EAT REGIONALLY

Taste Ilocano cooking, highland produce, Bicol seafood and Visayan flavours.

ASK, THEN LISTEN

Salamat means thank you. Warmth travels further than fluency.

LEAVE SPACE

A simple bowl eaten where daily life is happening may become the meal you remember.

A SHARED FILIPINO TABLE

Recipes, hospitality and conversation connect the landscapes of the journey.





TRAVEL NOTES

Useful, current, considered

Facts were checked against official sources in August 2026.
Entry, weather and operating conditions can change.

ENTRY AND EXTENSIONS

immigration.gov.ph/visas/visa-waiver/

WEATHER AND SEASONS

www.pagasa.dost.gov.ph/information/climate-philippines

POPULATION

psa.gov.ph/content/2024-census-population-popcen-population-counts-declared-official-president

BANAUE

whc.unesco.org/en/list/722/

VIGAN

whc.unesco.org/en/list/502/

BOHOL GEOPARK

www.unesco.org/en/igpp/geoparks/bohol-island



YOUR PHILIPPINES, DESIGNED AROUND YOU

BEYOND THE ORDINARY

DISCOVER THE PHILIPPINES

Tell us how you like to move, what you are curious about, and where you want more stillness.

START PLANNING YOUR JOURNEY

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